

While the Dalai Lama was setting up a “new” Tibet in India, things got even worse for those left behind. Mao Tse-tung made it his goal to get rid of all old ideas and customs. The Tibetan people had to change the way they dressed and even their language! Many people were killed. Many monasteries were torn down, and sacred texts and art were destroyed. The environment of Tibet was suffering, too. Forests were cut and the land polluted.

Over the next decades, the Dalai Lama grew from a young leader into a strong voice for his exiled nation. He visited many places in India and spoke about Tibet. He felt safe enough to leave India and spread the word in other Buddhist countries in Asia. In 1973, he visited European nations,